

Wexford Co.
Cadillac WWTP
Munich (201)



Cadillac Utilities Department

December 21, 2015

Dear Mr. Jamie Wade,

On the afternoon of Friday December 18th an incident occurred at the Cadillac Waste Water Treatment Plant. An operator was performing a routine chemical cleaning of our Aqua Disk cloth filtration system. The operator had bypassed the three tanks and pumped the tanks solids to the head works of the plant. The operator then refilled the tanks with approximately 6,000 gallons each of tertiary water. Five gallons of Grease B Gone degreaser was added in total to the three tanks. Upon adding the degreaser the operator set the tanks to recirculate for a few hours. After recirculation the operator would normally pump the chemical solution to the head works where it can be treated before restoring the tanks to normal operation. Instead the operator returned the tanks to normal operation sending the chemical solution to our effluent. This took place around 12:30 p.m.

At approximately 1:30 p.m. fish in the onsite fish tank appeared to become incapacitated. The fish tank is feed with the plants effluent. At this time the operator was instructed to bypass the Aqua Disk filtration tanks stopping the chemical solution from going to our effluent. Immediately following this you were contacted and personnel were sent out to observe the effluent. Plant personnel walked the river banks looking for any sign of the degreaser in the river. There was no sign or indication the chemical had impacted the river in anyway.

Some of the fish in the fish tank and minnow net did expire but the majority of the incapacitated fish returned to an active state within 20 to 30 minutes of redirecting the diluted cleaning solution. The Aqua Disk filtration tanks were then filled with tertiary water to further dilute and rinse the degreaser away. It was then pumped to the head works for treatment. This process was repeated three times before restoring the plant back to normal operation.

To prevent this or any other similar occurrences from happening in the future these processes will be gone over and more appropriate training will take place. Once again we would like to thank you for taking the time to come out and look things over.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Jeffrey M. Dietlin".

Jeffrey M. Dietlin
Utilities Director
City of Cadillac
(231)775-9326

DEC 21 2015